

The Suffix -able

I can add -able to make a new word.

Today I am learning to:

- ☐ understand -able
- ☐ build/read -able words
- ☐ review word families

1 Learn the Rule

The suffix -able often means able to be or suitable to be. When we add -able to a base word, we can make an adjective that tells us something can be done.

-able = able to be or can be done



readable

able to be read



washable

able to be washed



breakable

able to be broken



foldable

able to be folded



drinkable

safe/able to drink



countable

able to be counted

2 Add -able

Write the new word.

1. read + -able _____ 
2. wash + -able _____ 
3. break + -able _____ 
4. fold + -able _____ 
5. drink + -able _____ 
6. count + -able _____ 

3 Match the Meaning

Draw a line to match each word with its meaning.

readable

able to be folded

washable

able to be read

breakable

able to be counted

foldable

able to be washed

drinkable

able to be broken

countable

able to be drunk

4 Word Family Review

Use earlier prefixes and suffixes to complete the family.

- | | | | | | |
|-------------|---|---------|---|--------------|-------|
| read | → | reread | + | -able | _____ |
| help | → | helpful | + | -less | _____ |
| kind | → | unkind | + | -ness | _____ |
| play | → | replay | + | -able | _____ |
| care | → | careful | + | -less | _____ |

5 Use the Words

Choose a word from the bank to complete each sentence.

readable

washable

breakable

foldable

drinkable

countable

1. This book is easy to read, so it is _____.
2. This shirt can go in the wash, so it is _____.
3. Handle the glass carefully because it is _____.
4. The paper chair can be folded, so it is _____.
5. The water is safe to drink, so it is _____.

Challenge

Choose one base word. Make two related words using a prefix or suffix you know.

Word families connect spelling and meaning 😊